

Beyond KYC: Scaling High-Margin Enterprise Revenue in BFSI

A data-backed case for Tenacio's market positioning, built on TrustMRR's public database of verified startup revenue.

138

SECURITY STARTUPS ANALYZED

\$1.51B

REVENUE TRACKED ON TRUSTMRR

Aug 2026

DATA SNAPSHOT DATE

Where this data comes from — and why it matters

Every figure in the next slide is pulled directly from TrustMRR.com, not estimated — here’s what that source is and how we used it.

01

What TrustMRR is

A public database of startup revenue verified directly through payment processors like Stripe, RevenueCat and LemonSqueezy — not self-reported screenshots. It tracks \$1.51B+ in revenue across 53M transactions (snapshot: August 2026).

02

Why we used it

It’s one of the few places you can compare real Monthly Recurring Revenue — MRR, the predictable income a subscription business earns each month — across different types of software, broken down by category.

03

What we pulled

TrustMRR’s Security category (cybersecurity, privacy & identity companies), its Developer Tools/API and Fintech categories, and its own platform-wide “Most Profitable Categories” ranking.

Caveat: startups list themselves voluntarily, so the sample skews toward indie and bootstrapped founders — it isn’t a census of the software industry. Because every number is payment-provider verified, though, the pattern is directionally reliable.

Security & compliance software earns more — with far less competition

TrustMRR ranks every category on the platform by total revenue. Here’s how the categories relevant to Tenacio compare.

SECURITY	138 startups tracked	Ranked #2 of all categories on TrustMRR by total platform revenue
DEVELOPER TOOLS / API	1,187 startups tracked	The single largest category on the platform — does not place in the top 10 most profitable categories
FINTECH	375 startups tracked	Also outside the top 10 most profitable categories

The proof point: 1Lookup — a real-time phone, email & IP verification API — earns \$224,419/month, the 6th-highest revenue of any startup tracked on all of TrustMRR, across every category. Comp AI, a SOC 2/ISO 27001 compliance automation tool, has driven \$4.4M in lifetime tracked revenue.

What it means: a generic “verification API” or “fintech tool” label competes in the platform’s most crowded categories. A “security & compliance” label competes in one of its most profitable — with 8x fewer rivals.

What this means for Indian banks and lenders

Financial institutions face high customer drop-off, fragmented vendors, and a compliance deadline most haven’t started preparing for.

Vendor Fragmentation

Banks juggle 10+ separate identity-verification vendors (PAN, CERSAI, bank-account checks) just to run one KYC — “Know Your Customer” — check. That drives up cost and failure rates.

TENACIO ANSWER

Single API Orchestration

CONNECT

New-to-Credit Blindspot

400M+ Indians have no credit bureau history, so lenders either reject them outright or take on hidden default risk.

TENACIO ANSWER

Alternate Data Scoring

SENSE

The DPDP Deadline

India’s Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDP) 2023 requires proper consent and data-handling by May 14, 2027, with penalties reported up to ₹250 crore for non-compliance.

TENACIO ANSWER

Zero-Data-Egress Governance

SHIELD

How Tenacio answers each gap

Three connected products — one single integration. Connect brings the data in, Sense turns it into a decision, Shield keeps it compliant.

 SENSE

Customer Intelligence

Turns minimal inputs into a live customer profile — identity, value, intent and fraud propensity.

- ✓ Genuine identity confidence
- ✓ Purchase & investment propensity
- ✓ Fraud propensity & behavioural signals

 CONNECT

Onboarding Infrastructure

Orchestrates KYC, KYB, banking, employment, and fraud APIs through one single integration.

- ✓ KYC onboarding stack
- ✓ Bank verification & penny drop
- ✓ AI vendor routing & failover

 SHIELD

DPDP Compliance & Privacy

Consent management, data governance, and audit trails — in a zero-data-egress architecture.

- ✓ Tamper-proof consent (SHA-256)
- ✓ Data Points Registry & RoPA
- ✓ Zero data egress — on-premise

The DPDP “Trojan Horse” strategy

A compliance deadline solves the problem that normally stalls enterprise sales: nobody wants to switch a working vendor.

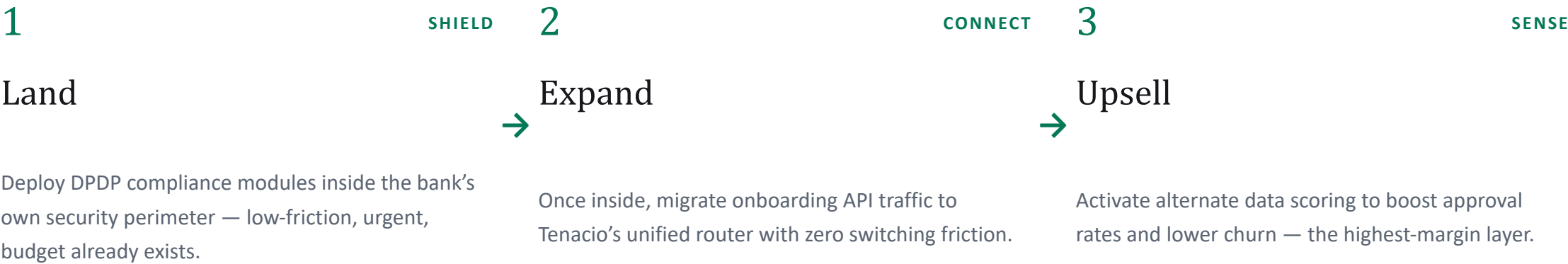
THE SALES BOTTLENECK

CTOs delay replacing a working KYC vendor because switching APIs carries real operational effort.

THE COMPLIANCE CATALYST

The DPDP deadline creates urgent, non-negotiable demand from CFOs, General Counsels, and DPOs to avoid penalties.

THE EXECUTION SEQUENCE



Hybrid pricing: frictionless volume + sticky retainers

Two revenue motions, working together — a low-friction entry point, and a high-ticket compliance retainer.

CONNECT

Usage-Based API Credits

MODEL

Micro-transaction fees per API verification lookup.

ADVANTAGE

Low entry barrier for clients; revenue scales dynamically with their onboarding volume — the same model that earns 1Lookup \$224k/month on TrustMRR.

SHIELD · SENSE

Enterprise SaaS & On-Premise Retainers

MODEL

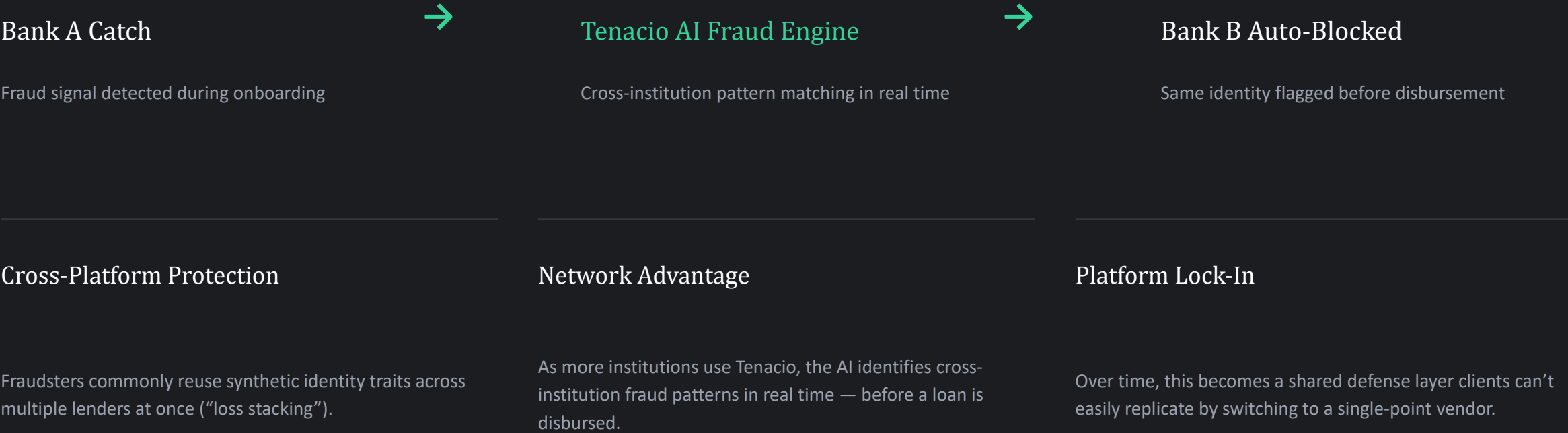
Flat monthly or annual fees based on active data modules and compliance auditing.

ADVANTAGE

High-ticket, predictable ARR secured through dedicated legal and security budgets — budgets that exist because of the DPDP deadline.

Why this gets harder to copy over time

As more institutions plug in, the same verification calls start protecting each other — turning a single API into a shared fraud shield.



This is the strategic bet the moat is built on — value compounds as adoption grows.

Why this positioning wins

Three reasons the data, the regulation, and the product all point the same direction.

1

Category Alignment

TrustMRR's own data shows security & compliance software outranks generic API and fintech categories — with 8x less competition.

2

Regulatory Tailwinds

The DPDP Act 2023 deadline (May 14, 2027) turns a legal headache into Tenacio's fastest, most urgent acquisition channel.

3

A Working Platform, Not a Pitch

Sense, Connect and Shield are live today — 50+ clients, 99.9% uptime, 98.4% onboarding success — delivering lower costs, higher approvals, and audit-ready compliance.